

# CS498 Week 1 - Reporting

January 2026

## Outline

This week will be focused on understanding the reporting process after completing a penetration test. This is integral in a business relationship as a thorough, well-formatted document will leave the client satisfied.

Please open the template of the standard report and watch the corresponding YouTube Video. The video will break down each section and its importance. Ensure you understand what the purpose of each section is. Then you will need to replicate this template on Overleaf in LaTeX as we will be using this in the future.

## Material

- [Template of Standard Report](#)
- [Youtube Video](#)
- [OWASP WSTG: Reporting Structure](#)
- [More professional and detailed report: Do not use for template](#)

## Deliverables

- [Google Form for Quiz 1](#)
- Submit a .pdf of your created template on Discord

## Quiz 1 Topics

- Reporting fundamentals
  - What makes a pentest report actionable (clarity, prioritization, reproducibility)
  - Executive summary vs. Technical detail
  - Severity/risk ratings: consistency and justification
    - \* Recommend diving deeper on Severity/Risk ratings
- Report Structure and Standards
  - Common pentest report sections (scope, findings, appendix, etc.)
  - How to write findings that are verifiable and testable
- Evidence and Documentation
  - Evidence Types: screenshots, logs, scan output, etc.
  - Evidence Handling: naming conventions, timestamps, appendices
- Professional/Industry context
  - How reports are used by different stakeholders (IT, Auditors, Leadership)
  - What "good" looks like by reading real professional reports